NOT MEASUREMENT SENSITIVE

MIL-STD-361-2(TM)
15 JULY 1992

SUPERSEDING
(See 6.5.)

MILITARY STANDARD

MANUALS, TECHNICAL:

COMPREHENSIBILITY REQUIREMENTS

AMSC A6751 AREA TMSS

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FOREWORD

1. This military standard is approved for use by the Department of the Army and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense (DOD).

2. Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, USAMC Materiel Readiness Support Activity, ATTN: AMXMD-EP, Lexington, Kentucky 40511-5101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

3. This document is one part of an 11-part bookform standard to be used in the preparation and acquisition of technical manuals that are essential to support (operate and maintain) the various types of equipment and weapon systems within the Department of the Army.

4. This document covers the comprehensibility and readability requirements for the preparation of technical manuals.

5. Other parts of this multipart standard are:

MIL-STD-361-1	-	Writing Style and Format Requirements.
MIL-STD-361-3	-	Requirements for Graphics.
MIL-STD-361-4	-	Quality Assurance Requirements.
MIL-STD-361-5	-	Requirements for Packaging.
MIL-STD-361-6	-	Introductory Information with Theory of Operations Requirements.
MIL-STD-361-7	-	Operator and Preventive Maintenance Instructions.
MIL-STD-361-8	-	Maintenance Instructions.
MIL-STD-361-9	-	Troubleshooting Procedures.
MIL-STD-361-10	-	Lubrication Instructions.
MIL-STD-361-11	-	Repair Parts and Special Tools List (RPSTL).

6. By incorporating standardized and service-unique technical manual requirements, this document and its dash-numbered companion parts, along with the general acquisition specification MIL-M-63008, Acquisition/Preparation Requirements, support the acquisition of technical manuals.

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1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document establishes requirements relating to comprehensibility for preparation of technical manuals (TMs), revisions, supplements, and changes.

1.2 Purpose. This comprehensibility document supplements the various requirements in the other parts to this 11-part standard for specific types of technical manuals and related publications and does not alone deliver any technical data.

1.3 Applicability. The applicability of the requirements contained in this document is governed by the equipment, systems, or weapon systems for which the technical manuals are being developed. This document is applicable for use by the Department of the Army.

1.4 Selective application and tailoring. This document contains some requirements that may not be applicable to the preparation of all technical manuals. Selective application and tailoring of requirements contained in this document are the responsibility of the contracting activity and shall be accomplished through the use of MIL-M-63008. The applicability of some requirements is also designated by one of the following statements:

- unless requirement is specifically excluded by the contracting activity; or
- as/when specified by the contracting activity.

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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation. (See 6.2.)

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-M-63008	-	Manuals, Technical: Acquisition/Preparation Requirements.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-361-1	-	Manuals, Technical: Writing Style and Format Requirements.
MIL-STD-361-3	-	Manuals, Technical: Requirements for Graphics.
MIL-STD-361-4	-	Manuals, Technical: Quality Assurance Requirements.
MIL-STD-361-5	-	Manuals, Technical: Requirements for Packaging.
MIL-STD-361-6	-	Manuals, Technical: Introductory Information with Theory of Operations Requirements.
MIL-STD-361-8	-	Maintenance Instructions.
MIL-STD-361-9	-	Manuals, Technical: Troubleshooting Procedures.

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications and standards are available from Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5904.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents and publications. The following other Government document/publication forms a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issue is that cited in the solicitation.

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Library of Congress
Catalog
No. Z253.U58 - U.S. Government Printing Office (GPO) Style Manual.

(Copies of the GPO Style Manual are available from the U.S. Government Printing Office, ATTN: Superintendent of Documents, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document ("This document" includes all volumes of MIL-STD-361 series.) and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

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3. DEFINITIONS

3.1 Acronyms used in this standard. The acronyms used in this standard are defined as follows:

a. DOD - Department of Defense.

b. DODISS - Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards.

c. GL - Grade Level.

d. GPO - Government Printing Office.

e. OGL - Overall Grade Level.

f. RGL - Reading Grade Level.

g. RPSTL - Repair Parts and Special Tools List.

h. TM - Technical Manual.

3.2 Callout. Anything placed on an illustration to aid in identifying the objects being illustrated, such as index numbers, nomenclature, leader lines, and arrows.

3.3 Clutter. A condition in which the amount of information in a given area is so great that confusion and errors of interpretation occur.

3.4 Comprehensibility. The completeness with which a user in the target audience understands the information in the TM.

3.5 Functional diagram. A type of illustration in which symbols are connected by lines to show relationships among the symbols. The symbols may be rectangles or other shapes, standard symbols representing components or functions, or pictorials representing equipment or components. The lines may represent procedures or processes, such as signal or logic flow, and physical items, such as wires. Functional diagram includes schematics, wiring and piping diagrams, logic diagrams, flow charts, and block diagrams.

3.6 Illustration. A general term meaning graphic presentations of all types. Illustrations include pictorials, functional diagrams, and line graphs. This term is used instead of such terms as figure, graphic, drawing, diagram, and artwork.

3.7 Line graph. A type of illustration that shows one or more relationships between two variables. Values of the variables are indicated on the horizontal and vertical axes. The relationships between the axes variables are indicated by lines (curves, straight line segments, bars, or other devices as applicable).

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3.8 Logic tree. Diagram comprised of a branching series of questions, resulting in a "yes" or "no" answer, leading to determination and resolution of problem.

3.9 Nomenclature. The approved name or alphanumeric identifier assigned to an item, equipment, or component in agreement with an organized designation system.

3.10 Pictorial. A type of illustration showing the physical appearance of equipment or component parts. This term is used instead of such general terms as illustration, drawing, and diagram.

3.11 Procedure. The sequence of actions that make up a task.

3.12 Readability. Text comprehensibility measured by such variables as number of syllables, words, and sentences.

3.13 Reading grade level (RGL). A measurement of reading difficulty of text related to grade levels (such as ninth grade level, fourteenth grade level, etc.).

3.14 Style. Denotes differences in design or appearance.

3.15 Tailoring. The process of evaluating individual potential requirements to determine their pertinence and cost effectiveness. The tailoring of data requirements is limited to the exclusion of information requirement provisions.

3.16 Task. A sequence of user actions with a beginning and an end. User tasks relate to installation, checkout, operation, and maintenance of systems or equipment.

3.17 Technical manuals (TMs). Manuals that contain instructions for the installation, operation, maintenance, and support of weapon systems, weapon system components, and support equipment. TM information may be presented, according to prior agreement between the contractor and the Government, in any form or characteristic, including hard printed copy, audio and visual displays, electronic embedded media, disks, other electronic devices, or other media. They normally include operational and maintenance instructions, parts lists, and related technical information or procedures exclusive of administrative procedures.

3.18 Type. Implies differences in like items or processes relative to design, model, shape, or other factors and is usually designated by Roman numerals (e.g., Type I, Type II).

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4. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

4.1 Objective. Technical manuals (TMs) prepared to this document shall conform to the comprehensibility requirements herein and to the reading grade level (RGL) provided by the contracting activity. Appendixes A and B shall be used for sampling material and calculating the RGL.

4.2 Style of writing. The text shall be concise, accurate, and in simplified English. Articles may be excluded for brevity only when appropriate.

4.2.1 Equipment/user interface. With respect to equipment/user interface, the following shall be done:

a. Detailed task steps shall be identified and then properly worded for the target audience.

b. Task steps shall be organized in a logical order and presented so that they sequentially list what the user sees or detects on the equipment at each step of the procedure.

c. When essential to support the procedures, illustrations shall be used to highlight the task steps, and locator views shall be used to orient the user with the major components of the equipment (See MIL-STD-361-3.) and with the area affected by the procedure. The illustrations shall reflect how the user actually sees the equipment in terms of angle of view in order to assist the user to focus on the equipment part to be acted upon.

d. Text and illustrations shall be integrated into a clear, comprehensive module of information that will enable the user to relate readily from the printed word supported by graphics to the equipment itself. Whenever possible, text and illustrations should be arranged to be visible simultaneously.

4.2.2 Organization of the TM. The TM shall be organized in accordance with the applicable content matrix. (See MIL-M-63008.) The operator's and maintenance procedures shall be sequenced in accordance with the Maintenance Allocation Chart.

4.3 Consolidation of material. To help keep the TM user in one area of the TM for each task and to the extent possible, all information required to complete a single task shall be put in one place. (When referencing is required, see MIL-STD-361-1.)

4.4 Word choice.

4.4.1 Vocabulary. The simplest, most familiar, and most concrete words that accurately convey the intended meaning shall be used. Preferred usage shall be short words and words used in ordinary conversation. Words which have more than one meaning

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which will fit the context in which they are used, such as "replace" for "reinstall," shall not be used. Highly technical terms shall be limited to circumstances where simpler terms would not accurately convey the intended meaning and shall be defined directly after their use or in a glossary. (See MIL-STD-361-1.) The following explanation of the use of the term nuclear hardness is an example: "The nuclear hardness (the ability to survive a nuclear environment) of the equipment shall not be degraded during operation and maintenance."

4.4.2 Concrete and specific language. Concrete and specific language shall be used to reduce vagueness.

Example 1:

Abstract and general: "Precautions should be taken against fire."

Concrete and specific: "Inspect fire doors and automatic sprinkler system monthly."

Example 2:

Abstract and general: "It is wise to make the area comfortable and to make provisions for shutting out noise from the shop."

Concrete and specific: "Air-condition the area and soundproof the walls."

4.4.3 Simple versus elaborate wording. Simple wording shall be used.

Examples:

Simple	Elaborate
About	As to, with regard to
After	Subsequent to
Because	Inasmuch as, for the reason that
Before	Prior to
Find out	Ascertain
For	For the purpose of
If	In the event that
Must, need	Necessitate

4.4.4 Nomenclature. Nomenclature shall be consistent throughout the TM or series of manuals and shall match official (i.e., RPSTL) nomenclature. Refer to MIL-STD-361-1 and MIL-STD-361-6.

4.4.5 Common equipment names. When a common name is used instead of the official, approved nomenclature, both shall be listed in a nomenclature cross reference list. (See MIL-STD-361-6.) This will assist the user in locating the item when referring to other text or lists which do use the approved nomenclature. Approved nomenclature shall be used wherever the use of a common name might be ambiguous.

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4.4.6 Abbreviations and acronyms. Abbreviations and acronyms shall be used sparingly. They shall be spelled out upon the first use. Abbreviations and acronyms shall be used for those systems, subsystems, equipment, components, organizations, or other items that are ordinarily referred to by their abbreviations or acronyms by the TM user. When abbreviations or acronyms are used as markings on the equipment (placarding), the same abbreviations or acronyms shall be used in the TM.

4.5 Sentence structure and grammar.

4.5.1 Word order for descriptive text. Narrative text (not procedures) shall be written using simple word order (subject, verb, object) to the extent possible. Modifiers, including prepositional phrases, shall be as close as possible to the word modified. Simple word order shall ordinarily be used for description and discussion statements such as notes, cautions, and warnings.

4.5.2 Standard English grammar. Rules of grammar for standard American English as found in the U.S. Government Printing Office Style Manual shall be used. Colloquial and slang expressions shall not be used.

4.6 Procedural text format.

4.6.1 Sentences in procedures. Sentences directing the actions of the user should begin with the verb (e.g., "Remove four screws (1) and cover (2)."). If more than one person is involved, the directions shall be in the active voice, for example, "Cannoneer 1 shall ... while Cannoneer 2 ... ."

4.6.2 Positive form. Procedural steps shall be in positive form (i.e., "Close container." rather than "Do not leave container open.") unless the meaning demands the negative form.

4.7 Illustrations and tables. Preparation of illustrations and tables shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-361-3.

4.7.1 Use of illustrations. Illustrations shall support the text as necessary. Style and techniques used shall produce illustrations that will clearly, adequately, and economically portray the information to be illustrated. Illustrations shall be used to describe an item, process, or procedure; clarify text; present information difficult to describe by text alone; call attention to details; and provide identification of assemblies, parts, and tools, etc. Number or nomenclature callouts shall be used to key important items in the illustration to the text. If the same illustration is referred to in procedural steps on a number of pages, the illustration may be repeated.

4.7.2 Nearness of illustrations and text. Where possible, text and related illustrations shall be arranged so they can be viewed at the same time. If this is not possible (e.g., more than one full-page illustration), the illustrations shall be placed as soon after the first reference as possible.

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4.7.3 Titles of illustrations and tables. Each referenced illustration or table shall have a title. The title shall identify the contents or purpose of its illustration or table and distinguish that illustration or table from others in the TM.

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5. DETAILED REQUIREMENTS

5.1 Paragraph titles. A title shall identify the content of the material that it heads. "General" and "Miscellaneous" shall not be used unless no other title will suffice. All material under a single title shall be consistent with the title. Titles shall be informative and serve two purposes. First, they shall make access to information easier by permitting the reader to scan a page to find the desired information. Second, they shall alert the reader to the type of information contained in the text to follow. (See also MIL-STD-361-1.)

Examples:

Noninformative title	Informative title
Procedure	Procedure for recording temperature
Instrumentation	Heat measured by thermocouples
Discussion	Reasons for waveform variations
General description	Symbols created for radar PPI

5.2 Typography. Typography shall be in accordance with Table I. Except for pocket size TMs, type size shall be no smaller than 8 point. For pocket TMs, type size shall be no smaller than 6 point.

TABLE I. Style, capitalization, leading, and spacing.

Use	Preferred Font Type/Size	Capitalization	Leading	Vertical Spacing
TM no.	Sans Serif Bold 10	Uppercase		30 points from top of page
Page no.	Sans Serif Bold 10			30 points from bottom of page
Change no.	Sans Serif Bold 10	Upper- and lowercase		30 points from bottom of page
Security classification	Sans Serif Bold 14	Uppercase		*30 points from top and bottom of page
Deleted page notation	Serif Bold 8	Upper- and lowercase	2	30 points from top or bottom of page
Chapter no. and header	Sans Serif Bold 14	Uppercase	6	48 points below TM no.; 18 points above text, table, or illustration
Section no. and header	Sans Serif Bold 14	Uppercase	6	28 points below TM no. or 24 points below chapter header; 18 points above text, table, or illustration

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TABLE I. Style, capitalization, leading, and spacing. - Continued.

Use	Preferred Font Type/Size	Capitalization	Leading	Vertical Spacing
Warning Summary, Table of Contents, How To Use This Manual, Index, Glossary, and Appendix headers	Sans Serif Bold 14	Uppercase		48 points below TM no.; 18 points above text
Text	Serif 10	Upper- and lowercase	1	18 points below TM no., chapter/section header; 12 points above/below table or illustration; 6 points above page no.; 6 points above/below warning, caution, and note headers
Emphasis	Italic Bold 10	Upper- and Lowercase	1	
Formulas and Equations	Italic 10	Upper- and lowercase	1	12 points above/below text, table, or illustration
Primary titles	Sans Serif Bold 10	Uppercase	2	18 points below TM no., chapter/section header; 12 points above/below text, table, or illustration; 6 points above/below warning, caution, and note headers
Subordinate paragraph titles	Sans Serif Bold 10	Upper- and lowercase	2	18 points below TM no., chapter/section header; 12 points above/below table or illustration; 6 points above/below warning, caution, and note headers
Figure no. and title	Serif or Italic 10	Uppercase for first letter of each principal word	2	18 points below illustration
Legend text	Sans Serif 8	Uppercase for first letter of first word	1	28 points above illustration
Legend on artwork	Sans Serif 8	Uppercase for first letter of first word	1	As required
Illustration callouts	Sans Serif 8	Uppercase		As required
Table no. and title	Serif or Italic Bold 10	Uppercase for first letter of each principal word	2	18 points above table

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TABLE I. Style, capitalization, leading, and spacing. - Continued.

Use	Preferred Font Type/Size	Capitalization	Leading	Vertical Spacing
Boxhead titles	Serif Bold 10	Uppercase	1	
Table text	Serif 10	Upper- and lowercase	2	
Rules	3/4th point width			
Footnotes	Serif 8	Upper- and lowercase	1	18 points below text or table
Warnings and cautions headers	Sans Serif Extra Bold 10	Uppercase		6 points above and below text
Notes headers	Sans Serif Extra Bold 10	Uppercase		6 points above and below text
Repair Parts and Special Tools List (RPSTL) Parts List and Special Tools List and Cross-Reference Indexes (National Stock Number Index, Part Number Index, and Reference Designator Index) column headers	Sans Serif 8	Uppercase	1	
RPSTL text	Sans Serif 8 or 10	Upper- and lowercase	1	
Cover: Security Classification	Sans Serif Bold 24	Uppercase		
Cover: TM Number	Sans Serif Bold 24	Uppercase		
Cover: Words "Technical Manual"	Sans Serif Bold 14	Uppercase		
Cover: Type of Publication	Sans Serif Bold 14	Uppercase		
Cover: Maintenance Levels	Sans Serif Bold 14	Uppercase		
Cover: Nomenclature of Equipment	Sans Serif Bold 18 - 24	Uppercase		
Cover: Type, Model, Part Number, National Stock Number, EIC, or Subject	Sans Serif Bold 18 - 24	Uppercase		
Cover: Subtitle (Volume Title and Number)	Sans Serif Bold 14	Uppercase		

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TABLE I. Style, capitalization, leading, and spacing. - Continued.

Use	Preferred Font Type/Size	Capitalization	Leading	Vertical Spacing
Cover: Availability Statement, Supersedure Notice, Disclosure Notice, Distribution Statement, Export Control Notice, Destruction Notice	Sans Serif Bold 8 for Header and Sans Serif 8 for Text	Uppercase for Header and Upper and Lowercase for Text		
Cover: Service Nomenclature	Sans Serif Bold 18	Uppercase		
Cover: Change Number and Date	Sans Serif Bold 14	Uppercase		
Cover: TM Date	Sans Serif Bold 18	Uppercase		

All type sizes may be plus or minus one point.
Slight variations in spacing and leading are permitted.
Final reproducible copy shall use above type sizes.

IT IS NOT THE INTENT OF THIS STANDARD TO SPECIFY THE METHODS OF COMPOSING EQUIPMENT TO BE USED, BUT ONLY TO SPECIFY REQUIRED RESULTS.

*When a TM is classified, the TM number shall be 48 points from the top of the page and the page number 48 points from the bottom of the page. All other spacing shall be adjusted accordingly.

5.3 Reading grade level (RGL) measurements. RGL shall be calculated using the procedures described in Appendix B. Measurements cited in these requirements shall be based either on the technical contents sections of the entire TM or on samples obtained by the method of Appendix A.

5.4 Procedural text content.

5.4.1 Form and content of procedures. To keep the text simple, a procedural step shall be limited to a single operation or to repetitions of a single operation with the following exceptions:

a. If simultaneous operations are required, they shall be listed together in the same step.

b. If the step is a major step, it shall express the action with a single verb (e.g., "Turn equipment ON.").

c. If the step represents a detailed procedure, as in b. above, but the procedure is so basic that the details should rarely be needed by the intended users, or if the procedure is very frequently repeated, such as turn on, turn off, and calibrate procedures, the step shall refer to the procedure with a single verb and cite a reference

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to the detailed steps (e.g., "Turn equipment ON. [See paragraph 3.46 for details.]"). (See 5.4.2.)

d. If needed, verification of the result of a procedure performed shall be included in the step (e.g., "Press push-button A and be sure indicator A is lit.").

5.4.2 Introduction to procedure. At the beginning of a procedure, before the procedural steps, introductory information shall be provided, if needed, to enable the user to carry out the procedure without interruption. (Not applicable to operator's TMs; see MIL-STD-361-8.) Examples of introductory information are:

a. References to relevant explanatory, descriptive, or theoretical material.

b. Number and qualifications of personnel required to carry out the procedure.

c. Test equipment required.

d. Special tools required.

e. Supplies and materials required.

f. Condition of the equipment at the beginning of the procedure and references to procedures required to establish this condition. (Chain referencing from task-to-task shall be avoided.)

g. Warning, if applicable, to note and obey safety notices in the text.

5.4.3 Lead-in. Procedural steps shall not be prefaced by a lead-in that merely duplicates the title as in the following example: "Disassembly of a sensing unit. The sensing unit is disassembled according to the following procedure: ..."

5.4.4 Relevance of procedural text. A procedure shall present only information necessary for completion of the task or that is directly helpful in preventing error.

5.4.5 Troubleshooting text comprehension. To assist the TM user in comprehending the troubleshooting procedures, troubleshooting procedures involving branches or multiple alternatives should be supported by graphic presentations such as logic trees and decision tables. Artwork, including locator art, may be used for further support. As specified by the contracting activity, troubleshooting tables may include functional descriptions explaining how the system or subsystem being diagnosed functions. (See MIL-STD-361-3 and -9 for examples of troubleshooting graphic presentations.)

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5.5 Nonprocedural text.

5.5.1 Topic sentence. The first sentence of each paragraph shall be the topic sentence. The topic sentence shall identify or summarize the content of the paragraph. All information in the paragraph shall relate to the topic sentence.

5.5.2 Separation of procedural and nonprocedural text. To keep the text easy to follow, explanatory, descriptive, or theoretical paragraphs shall not contain procedures, and procedures should not contain explanatory, descriptive, or theoretical material (except in notes, etc.).

5.6 Illustrations. Preparation of illustrations shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-361-3.

5.6.1 Functional and schematic diagrams.

5.6.1.1 Clutter in functional diagrams. Unless requirement is specifically excluded by the contracting activity, there shall be no more than three components per square inch on any page (page unit of a foldout). The number of line intersections allowable in a 2- by 2-in. area shall be 20 or less.

5.6.1.2 Component identity. Each component relevant to the text shall be identified. Where applicable, the wording on the diagram shall correspond exactly with the wording in the text.

5.6.1.3 Inputs and outputs. To help ensure diagram readability, all inputs and outputs shall be clearly identified. To the extent possible, and to keep diagram format consistent for readability, they shall be placed near the diagram edge with inputs at the left or top and outputs at the right or bottom.

5.6.1.4 Direction of signal flow. To assist the TM user in following the diagram, where possible, major signal or pressure flow shall be from left to right and feedback or return flow shall be from right to left. The direction of flow shall be indicated by arrows.

5.6.2 Wiring and piping diagrams.

5.6.2.1 Line layout. In single page diagrams, termination points shall be shown for every relevant wire or pipe. In multipage diagrams, unterminated line segments shall be identified by appropriate symbols with references maintaining continuity from page to page. The diagrams shall be laid out to eliminate jogs in lines where possible and to minimize the number of crossing lines. There shall be no more than 20 line intersections (whether or not they indicate physical connections) in any 2- by 2-in. area.

5.6.2.2 Component identification. For locating information, relevant components shall be identified on the diagram or referenced to an explanatory listing.

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5.6.3 Pictorials.

5.6.3.1 Line drawings. Line drawings shall be used to eliminate irrelevant detail, emphasize relevant information, and allow flexibility in viewpoint and scale. For clarity of information, line drawings shall be used instead of continuous tone art, such as photographs (halftones) and airbrush drawings.

5.6.3.2 Plane of view. When practical, the view of objects in pictorials shall be identical to the view the user sees when performing the task.

5.6.3.3 Locator views (detail views). When the location of the illustrated part is not obvious, a locator view with directional arrows to a detailed view shall be provided. (See MIL-STD-361-3.)

5.6.3.4 Axis lines. To assist in location, the relationship of all parts in an exploded view shall be clearly indicated by axis lines. (See MIL-STD-361-3.)

5.6.3.5 Callouts. See MIL-STD-361-3.

5.6.3.5.1 Placement of callouts. When practical, all callouts shall be placed outside the boundaries of the parts illustrated so that the parts shall not be obscured.

5.6.3.5.2 Callout leader lines. To assist the TM user in locating the item being called out, callout leader lines or arrows shall be straight lines where possible and shall not cross each other.

5.6.3.5.3 Clutter from callouts. Callouts shall be clearly legible and easily distinguishable from each other. Callouts and their leader lines shall be easily distinguishable from components and other lines of the illustration.

5.6.4 Line graphs.

5.6.4.1 Clutter in line graphs. The number of ideas conveyed per graph shall be minimized. Line graphs shall depict a maximum of four relationships between the axis variables. To distinguish one from another, lines depicting relationships shall be coded.

5.6.4.2 Orientation of axes. If there is a natural orientation for the axes, for example, altitude on the vertical axis, the axes shall be so oriented.

5.6.4.3 Grid lines. The number of grid lines used shall be such that the user can read values to the required degree of accuracy. Size of the illustration shall be such that the grid lines shall be no less than 0.1 in. apart. Grid lines shall be lighter than the graph lines and shall not obscure detail necessary for proper use of the graph.

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5.6.4.4 Graph scales. Graph scales shall be linear or nonlinear as required for proper comprehension and use. The axes shall be labelled to indicate the variables and units of measurement.

5.6.4.5 Instructions for use. For complex graphs, instructions shall be provided for use and interpretation.

5.7 Tables.

5.7.1 Units of measurement in tables. For ease of use, units of measurement shall be specified in row or column headings, as appropriate.

5.7.2 Interpolation. No interpolation (that is, estimation between tabled values) shall be required of the user. Interpolation shall be avoided by expanding the table or by presenting the data in a graph.

5.7.3 Alignment of entries in tables. For ease in readability, entries shall be aligned within columns as follows:

a. For decimal data, decimal points shall be aligned.

b. For scientific notation, multiplication signs shall be aligned.

c. All other numeric data shall be aligned flush right.

d. Alphabetic or alphanumeric data shall be aligned flush left.

5.7.4 Clutter in tables. To allow the reader to quickly locate the information, the row entries in tables should be arranged in groups of up to five rows. If all columns in a table have entries, groups of rows shall be separated with clear space. If some entries are missing, light horizontal lines shall be used to separate the groups. To avoid clutter within tables, there shall also be clear space between columns.

5.8 Quality assurance provision. Quality assurance and quality control for technical manuals, revisions, supplements, and changes shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-361-4.

5.9 Packaging and preparation for delivery. TMs, revisions, supplements, and changes shall be packaged in accordance with MIL-STD-361-5.

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6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. This document prescribes the comprehensibility requirements applicable to various types of technical manuals, revisions, supplements, and changes prepared by or for the Department of the Army.

6.2 Issue of DODISS. When this document is used in acquisition, the applicable issue of the DODISS must be cited in the solicitation. (See 2.1.1.)

6.3 Tailoring guidance. The contracting activity should tailor any required options offered herein in accordance with MIL-M-63008.

6.4 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this standard.

b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and, if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced. (See 2.1.1.)

c. Reading grade level (RGL) of the target audience (4.1; Appendix A, 40.4).

6.5 Supersession data. This document consolidates, standardizes, and supersedes the comprehensibility requirements contained in the following documents:

MIL-M-49502(TM)	-	Manuals, Technical: Repair Parts and Special Tools List.
MIL-M-49504(TM)	-	Manuals, Technical: Combat Vehicle Precombat Checklist.
MIL-M-63004C(TM)	-	Manuals, Technical: Preparation of Lubrication Orders.
MIL-M-63036D(TM)	-	Manuals, Technical: Operators, Preparation of.
MIL-M-63038C(TM)	-	Manuals, Technical: Organizational and Aviation Unit, Direct Support or Aviation Intermediate, and General Support Maintenance.
MIL-M-63041D(TM)	-	Manuals, Technical: Preparation of Depot Maintenance Work Requirements.

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6.6 Subject term (key word) listing. The following terms are to be used to identify this document during retrieval searches:

Axis lines
Callouts
Clutter
Consolidation
Diagrams
Grid lines
Interpolation
Line drawings
Locator views
Logic trees
Nonprocedural
Pictorial
Plane of view
Procedural and nonprocedural text
Selective application and tailoring
Specification
Typography

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APPENDIX A

SAMPLING PLAN FOR INSPECTION OF TECHNICAL MANUALS

10. SCOPE

10.1 Scope. This appendix provides a uniform sampling plan which may be used for in-process reviews, validation, etc. (Sampling plans used by contractors are to be described in the Technical Manual Quality Assurance (TMQA) program plan. See MIL-STD-361-4.) Sampling is not to be used for conduct of verifications. This appendix is not a mandatory part of the standard. The information contained herein is intended for guidance only.

10.2 Application. Sampling inspection in quality conformance is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements. A sampling plan is appropriate when the number of characteristics to be checked makes 100 percent evaluation excessively time consuming and costly for the TM being inspected. Simple random sampling of pages is not an adequate method as a TM is not a homogeneous mass and different tests require different types and amounts of sample material.

10.3 Sampling types. The plan presented here uses a mixture of random sampling by type of material and scanning by the reviewer to detect instances of nonconformance.

20. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS. This section is not applicable to this appendix.

30. DEFINITIONS. This section is not applicable to this appendix.

40. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

40.1 Derivation of samples. Samples to be tested are obtained as a result of the processes of 40.1.1 and 40.1.2.

40.1.1 Critical scanning. The purpose of critical scanning by the reviewer is to locate instances of suspected nonconformance for specific testing. Each page of the entire TM should be scanned for obvious nonconformance with a requirement of this standard; appropriate tests should then be applied to that material.

40.1.2 Systematic sampling. The purpose of systematic sampling is to provide semirandom samples of different types of material throughout the TM for detailed examination and testing. Different tests require different types and amounts of sample material. In general, the method of deriving samples is to identify a number of equally spaced "break" pages and to define sample material with reference to these break pages. (See 50.2.)

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40.2 Applicable tests. Sample material is to be examined or tested in detail for conformance with the requirements of this standard. In most instances, the nature of the tests is implicit in the statement of the requirements. This is not the case for reading grade level (RGL) requirements (See 5.3.), and additional detail is provided in Appendix B.

40.3 Extended local samples. Under the assumption that the material surrounding an instance of nonconformance has a higher probability of containing more such instances, extended local sampling provides additional sample material for examination. (See 50.3.)

40.4 Validation of readability. Narrative text is to be validated for conformance to the reading grade level (RGL) as provided by the contracting activity. If the Overall Grade Level (OGL) (including tolerance) is exceeded, the TM needs to be rewritten as required to meet the specified RGL. If a sample Grade Level (GL) is exceeded, the entire text surrounding each sample is to be rewritten as required.

50. DETAILED REQUIREMENTS

50.1 Critical scanning. Each page of the TM should be scanned by the reviewer. Grounds for suspected nonconformance include, but are not limited to, the criteria of 50.1.1 through 50.1.3.

50.1.1 Scanning criteria for procedures. Scanning criteria for procedures are as follows:

a. Procedural step does not begin with a verb.

b. Procedural step is in negative form (i.e., do not ...).

c. Procedural paragraph has no title.

d. Procedural steps are prefaced by an unnecessary lead-in which merely duplicates the title.

e. Procedure is not prefaced by relevant introductory information such as personnel required, special tools, test equipment, etc.

50.1.2 Scanning criteria for nonprocedural text. Scanning criteria for nonprocedural text are as follows:

a. Sentence(s) seem excessively long.

b. Paragraph has no title.

c. Paragraph title appears vague.

d. There is no topic sentence.

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e. There are procedures in nonprocedural text.

50.1.3 Scanning criteria for illustrations and tables. Scanning criteria for illustrations and tables are as follows:

a. Portions of image area appear cluttered:

(1) Too many symbols on a functional or schematic diagram.

(2) Too many line intersections on a functional, wiring, or piping diagram.

(3) Too many lines on a graph.

b. Print seems too small.

c. Callouts are hard to distinguish; arrangement or placement of callouts appears unacceptable.

d. Inputs are not at the left or top or outputs are not the at right or bottom on a functional or schematic diagram.

e. Signal flow does not read from left to right or feedback/return flow from right to left on a functional or schematic diagram.

f. Signal flow direction is not indicated by arrows on a functional or schematic diagram.

g. Locator view is required.

h. Table appears crowded - no aids to staying in correct row or column.

i. Halftone (photograph or shading) is used.

j. Illustration/table is not located close to the text where referenced.

k. Referenced figure/table has no title.

l. Exploded view has no axis lines.

50.2 Systematic sampling.

50.2.1 Identifying break pages. Break pages are pages that are equally spaced throughout the TM beginning with a randomly selected page. They are used as reference points to develop different types of samples as described in subsequent paragraphs.

a. Count the number of pages of text or illustrations (or whatever is being sampled) in the TM. The count should

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include all full and partial pages that contain the item to be sampled. Record the number of pages.

b. The basic number of samples is determined by the following:

No. of Pages	Divisor Divided by "N"	Basic No. of Samples Min.	Max.
90 and above	10	9	30
54 to 89	9	6	9
32 to 53	8	4	6
1 to 31	6	2	4

c. Divide the number of pages by the appropriate divisor, "N." Round off the quotient to the next lowest whole number. For example, quotients of 17.3 and 17.7 are both rounded off to 17. This quotient will equal the basic number of samples to be analyzed.

d. For TMs of less than 12 pages, randomly select two samples and mark them for analysis.

e. For TMs of 12 pages or more, randomly select a number between one and "N." The number selected is to be marked as the first page to be analyzed. Starting at the selected page, mark every "Nth" page to the end of the TM. The marked pages will identify approximate starting points for the basic samples to be analyzed.

f. Check marked pages to verify that at least one sample has been selected for each chapter of the TM. If any chapter has been missed, randomly select one page from that chapter and add it to the basic samples to be analyzed. Ensure that the portion sampled represents the type of text (or whatever) that makes up the majority of the chapter (i.e., a procedure versus descriptive text).

50.2.2 Samples of procedural text. Beginning with each break page, the first complete procedure and subsequent complete procedures as needed are to be selected until the total number of procedural steps exceeds 20. For suspected nonconformance identified by critical scanning, the above sampling process is to be applied beginning with the suspected procedure.

50.2.3 Samples of nonprocedural text.

50.2.3.1 Calculation of RGL. Beginning with each break page, at least two hundred words should be sampled. For suspected nonconformance identified by critical scanning, material is selected as above, but begins with the suspected paragraph.

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50.2.3.2 Other tests on nonprocedural text. Six-page samples beginning with each break page should be selected. For each instance of suspected nonconformance identified by critical scanning, a six-page sample surrounding each suspected instance should be selected.

50.2.4 Samples of illustrations and tables. A sample of each different type of illustration, and a sample of each table needs to be obtained.

50.2.4.1 Sampling method for illustrations. Beginning with each break page, the first example encountered of each illustration type is to be selected (ignoring those already selected when text was sampled), no matter where in the TM it occurs. The intent of this procedure is to generate a sample for each graphic type no larger than the number of break pages and to sample each graphic type adequately, whether they are spread out through the TM or are clustered together.

50.2.4.2 Tables. A sample of tables is to be selected by the same method.

50.3 Extended local samples.

50.3.1 Procedural text. Material in the vicinity of a confirmed instance of nonconformance is to be checked for similar nonconformance, using the two procedures immediately before the nonconforming procedure and the two procedures immediately following. If three or more of the five procedures are nonconforming, the entire chapter may be suspected of nonconformance and measures to correct it implemented.

50.3.2 Nonprocedural text.

50.3.2.1 Samples for RGL calculation. If nonconformance is found, RGL should be calculated from the pages three pages before and three pages following the nonconforming material using the method of Appendix B. If two or more of the three samples are nonconforming, the entire chapter may be suspected of nonconformance and measures to correct it implemented.

50.3.2.2 Other tests on nonprocedural text. If nonconformance is found, material in the two six-page samples immediately adjacent to the nonconforming sample should also be tested for conformance. If two or more of the three samples are nonconforming, the entire chapter may be suspected of nonconformance and measures to correct it implemented.

50.3.3 Illustrations and tables. Material in the vicinity of a confirmed instance of nonconformance is to be checked for similar nonconformance, using two examples of the same illustration type or table immediately before the nonconforming one and two examples immediately following it. All illustrations and tables

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in the chapter should be rescanned for potential nonconformance of all kinds.

50.4 Special cases of sampling.

50.4.1 Short TMs. If there are fewer than six pages between break pages, use as samples all material between break pages instead of six-page samples previously specified.

50.4.2 Material already sampled. For any particular test, if the material has already been sampled, the test results already obtained will be used.

50.4.3 Availability of material. If the amount of material called for does not exist, all available material is to be used.

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APPENDIX B

READING GRADE LEVEL MEASURES

10. SCOPE

10.1 Scope. The intent of these procedures is to furnish useful quantitative measures for three characteristics contributing to comprehensibility of text, namely, number of syllables, words, and sentences. This appendix contains a method for calculating the reading grade level (RGL) for TMs or portions thereof. This appendix is not a mandatory part of the standard. The information contained herein is intended for guidance only.

10.2 Application. The procedures described provide necessary detail for implementation of 5.3.

20. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS. This section is not applicable to this appendix.

30. DEFINITIONS

30.1 Sentence. A group of words conveying a complete thought and terminated by a semicolon, period, exclamation mark, or question mark. Headers, captions, and paragraph titles are not considered sentences.

30.2 Syllable. The way the word is normally pronounced aloud. For example, "at" is one syllable, "maintain" is two syllables, "area" is three syllables, "panoramic" is four syllables, and "recuperated" is five syllables.

30.3 Word. Any string of characters (including letters, numbers, symbols, and groups of letters) separated from other strings by one or more spaces. Hyphenated words and contractions count as one word. For example, each of the following count as one word: couldn't; GFE; i.e.; 32,008; 19-inch; +25°F; left-hand. Thus a sentence like "The left-hand MLG door shouldn't open more than 25°." consists of 9 words.

40. DETAILED REQUIREMENTS

40.1 Counts for narrative text. For each sample marked, raw data must be collected. Data collection will consist of counts of the numbers of words, sentences, and syllables in each sample. The size of the sample is based on the number of words to be analyzed. Samples will start at the beginning of the first full paragraph on each marked sample page. If a sample falls on a page containing procedural instructions, start the sample at the beginning of the first full sentence on the page.

40.1.1 Words. For each sample, count all words up to the end of the sentence containing the 200th word. If the marked sample page is less than 200 words, sample can be extended to next page of text; but, do not extend sample into a new chapter or text

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pertaining to a completely new subject. Record the number of words in each sample.

40.1.2 Sentences. Count all sentences in sample including the sentence that contains the 200th word. Record the number of sentences in each sample.

40.1.3 Syllables. Count syllables the way the word is normally pronounced aloud. Count all numbers as one syllable. For example, 5.1, 65, and 300 all count as one syllable each. However, if a numeric expression contains several numbers separated by hyphens, count each number as a syllable. For example, the expression 9-1025-240-10 is counted as four syllables. Acronyms and abbreviations are counted as one syllable unless they actually spell out a word of more than one syllable. For example, Hz and DVM each count as one syllable, but TRADOC and AMCCOM each count as two syllables. Record the number of syllables in each sample.

40.2 Automatic counting equipment. Devices for obtaining keystroke, word, and sentence counts automatically as text is input may be used. Keystroke counts will then substitute for syllable counts.

40.3 Calculation of reading grade level (RGL). Automated equipment and software may be used to calculate RGL provided the computation meets the requirements of this document.

40.3.1 Overall grade level. The Overall Grade Level (OGL) of a TM is calculated as follows:

a. Add the total number of words (W) from all samples combined. Record total.

b. Add the total number of sentences (S) from all samples combined. Record total.

c. Add the total number of syllables (P) from all samples combined. Record total.

d. Calculate the average sentence length (A). Divide the total number of words (W) by total number of sentences (S): (A = W/S). Round off quotient to the nearest one hundredth. Record quotient.

e. Calculate the average number of syllables per word (B). Divide total number of syllables (P) by total number of words (W): (B = P/W). Round off quotient to the nearest one hundredth. Record quotient.

f. Calculate the OGL of the TM by the following formula. Round off the OGL to the nearest integer.

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APPENDIX B

OGL = 0.39(A) + 11.8(B) - 15.59

SAMPLE COMPUTATIONS TO DEMONSTRATE USE OF FORMULAS

Sample	Total No. Words	Total No. Sentences	Total No. Syllables
1	250	30	500
2	220	35	475
3	245	28	420
4	223	22	400
5	256	32	510
6	215	27	398
7	219	26	395
8	230	30	400
9	225	29	380
10	226	28	370
10	W=2309	S=287	P=4248

A = W/S A = 2309/287 A = 8.05
B = P/W B = 4248/2309 B = 1.84

OGL = 0.39(A) + 11.8(B) - 15.59
OGL = 0.39(8.05) + 11.8(1.84) - 15.59
OGL = 3.14 + 21.71 - 15.59
OGL = 9

40.3.2 Sample grade levels. Calculate the Grade Level (GL) of each sample as follows:

a. Calculate the average sentence length (L). Divide the number of words (V) in the sample by the number of sentences (T) in the sample: (L = V/T). Round off quotient to the nearest one hundredth.

b. Calculate the average number of syllables per word (D). Divide the number of syllables (C) in the sample by the number of words (V) in the sample: (D = C/V). Round off quotient to the nearest one hundredth.

c. Calculate the Grade Level (GL) of each sample by the following formula. Round off each GL to the nearest integer.

GL = 0.39(L) + 11.8(D) - 15.59

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SAMPLE COMPUTATIONS TO DEMONSTRATE USE OF FORMULAS

Sample	Total No. Words	Total No. Sentences	Total No. Syllables
1	V1 = 250	T1 = 30	C1 = 500
2	V2 = 220	T2 = 35	C2 = 475
L1 = V1/T1	L1 = 250/30	L1 = 8.33	
D1 = C1/V1	D1 = 500/250	D1 = 2	
L2 = V2/T2	L2 = 220/35	L2 = 6.29	
D2 = C2/V2	D2 = 475/220	D2 = 2.16	

GL1 = 0.39(L1) + 11.8(D1) - 15.59
GL1 = 0.39(8.33) + 11.8(2) - 15.59
GL1 = 3.25 + 23.6 - 15.59
GL1 = 11

GL2 = 0.39(L2) + 11.8(D2) - 15.59
GL2 = 0.39(6.29) + 11.8(2.16) - 15.59
GL2 = 2.45 + 25.49 - 15.59
GL2 = 12

40.4 Counting technique. Obtaining accurate word and syllable counts rapidly can be aided by using a push-button operated counting device while reciting the text aloud. Certain hand-held electronic calculators can be used in this way.

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